

Medal of Honor: Allied Assault

<http://www.ea.com/moh/airborne/index.jsp>

June 6, 1944. Operation Overlord. While the world waited with bated breath, the biggest armada of ships in history descended on the beaches of Normandy to free Europe from the Nazis. Operation Overlord and the subsequent operations would not have been possible without the spies and saboteurs who risked torture and death to infiltrate deep behind enemy lines.

Now if you're a WWII freak, teenaged or not, you will like this game—because you actually get play an officer. (Stay away from the game if you'd rather be a Rottenführer!) To be precise, you play Lt Mike Powell from the American Office of Strategic Services. Your aim is to infiltrate German military installations and carry out activities like sab-

otage and intelligence gathering. You would also have to occasionally liaise with other covert officers to advance your objectives.

The game emphasises realism—all the weapons, vehicles, aircraft, and scenery look straight out of WWII. Powered by the *Quake 3* engine, the sceneries are highly detailed and rendered in 3D. Both single-player and multi-player modes are available.

With the tutorial in the beginning, you get to familiarise yourself with your weapons and the controls. Each mission starts off with a briefing; at this point you are outfitted with some weapons. You can also pick up stuff from fallen soldiers. On some missions, you get to wear a German uniform. Missions range from blasting sea-facing guns in North Africa to infiltrating U-boat bases in Norway. Wheel!

You get a good dose of history while you're enjoying the game... yes, it's that detailed.

EA Games' *Moh: AA* was released in 2002-2003, and retails at \$17.45.

Rating: 8/10



The bloody Schütze has seen you. Shoot!

Battle for Wesnoth

<http://www.wesnoth.org>



The Orcs, The Elves and the Mage

Wesnoth is one game that isn't too demanding on hardware. A long-time favourite with gamers, this is a turn-based strategy game, distinct from real-time strategy games. So you do what you want to do—based on your strategy—and then your opponent does what he wants to, and so on. The best known game in this genre is *Civilization*.

The campaigns here are set in different times and places in the fantasy world of *Wesnoth*. First, you build an army of races: you choose from among Elves, Orcs, Trolls, Humans, Dwarves—you get the idea. The challenge here is to build your own army such that each unit can be positioned to exercise its strengths. For instance, if you have an Elvish army fighting Orcs who don't have archers, position your archers near the marauding Orcs when it's your turn, and finish them off.

Each unit has a "favourite" terrain. One complicating, challenging feature is the day-night cycle: different units have more power depending on the time of day.

The AI is pretty good overall, and you can set the level of difficulty. Each campaign has its own scenarios and characters; you can also create customised maps and characters. If online, you can access user-generated content, too.

It's a good thing newbies can learn the ropes quickly—there's even a tutorial so you can familiarise yourself with basic commands like moving units around the map. In the end, the game feels like chess; you need to exercise your grey cells more than your aim-and-fire instincts!

Rating: 8.5/10